FINAL INTERNSHIP REPORT

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1. Introduction

An internship is an important part of academic and professional development because it provides students with an opportunity to connect theoretical knowledge with practical experience. It allows individuals to understand the working environment, develop professional skills, and gain practical knowledge of their chosen field. In the field of Applied English Linguistics, teaching practice is particularly valuable because it enables students to understand how language is taught and learned in real classroom situations. I am Shakeel Ahmed, a Master's student specializing in English Applied Linguistics at the University of Sindh, Jamshoro. As part of my academic and professional development, I completed my teaching internship at The Pioneers School and College, Jamshoro Campus (Higher Secondary). The main objective of this internship was to gain practical teaching experience, improve my classroom communication, understand students' learning needs, and apply the linguistic and grammatical knowledge acquired during my academic studies. I selected this institution to experience a real educational environment and understand the responsibilities of an English language teacher. Before beginning the internship, I expected to develop my teaching abilities, learn how to manage a classroom, and understand the difficulties students face while learning English grammar. The experience provided me with an opportunity to work with students from different educational levels and observe the relationship between theoretical knowledge and actual teaching practices.

2. Organization Profile

The Pioneers School and College, Jamshoro Campus, is an educational institution providing schooling and higher secondary education. It offers an academic environment in which students receive formal education and develop their knowledge and learning abilities. My internship was conducted at its Jamshoro Campus, where I was involved in English language and grammar teaching. The institution provided me with an opportunity to work with students belonging to different academic levels, including Grade 9, Matriculation, and First Year. The educational environment of the institution allowed me to understand how teachers perform their responsibilities and interact with students during classroom activities. It also helped me observe the importance of lesson explanation, classroom discipline, student participation, and regular practice in the teaching-learning process. During my internship, my primary focus was on teaching English grammar. I worked with students on different grammatical concepts, particularly parts of speech, tenses, and active and passive voice. These topics are important for developing students' grammatical understanding and improving their ability to construct accurate English sentences. My experience at the institution helped me understand the responsibilities involved in teaching English at the secondary and higher secondary levels.

3. Job Description and Tasks Performed

During my internship at The Pioneers School and College, Jamshoro Campus, my primary responsibility was to teach English grammar to students of Grade 9, Matriculation, and First Year. My teaching activities focused on explaining grammatical concepts, providing examples, engaging students in classroom discussions, and helping them understand the structure and use of English. One of the major topics I taught was Parts of Speech. I explained the different categories of words, including nouns, pronouns, verbs, adjectives, adverbs, prepositions, conjunctions, and interjections. I focused on their definitions, functions, and uses in sentences. I also used examples to help students recognize the grammatical roles of different words. Another important area of my teaching was Tenses. I explained how tenses express the time of an action and how different verb forms are used to construct sentences. I helped students understand the structures and functions of different tenses through examples and explanations. I also emphasized the importance of using appropriate verb forms when communicating in English. Furthermore, I taught Active and Passive Voice. I explained the differences between active and passive sentence structures and demonstrated how sentences can be transformed from one voice to another. I focused on identifying the subject, verb, and object and explaining the changes required during sentence transformation. My daily responsibilities involved conducting classroom lessons for approximately three hours. During these lessons, I explained topics, answered students' questions, provided examples, and helped students understand grammatical rules. I also had to prepare myself for lessons and consider how to explain difficult concepts in a simple and understandable way. Apart from classroom teaching, I spent approximately two additional hours at the institution waiting after completing my teaching responsibilities. This was part of my daily internship schedule. Overall, these responsibilities provided me with practical exposure to classroom teaching and helped me understand the preparation, patience, and consistency required to teach English effectively.

4. Learning Outcomes and Skills

My internship was a valuable learning experience because it helped me develop both teaching-related and professional skills. As a student of Applied English Linguistics, I had studied different aspects of language, grammar, and language learning. However, teaching in an actual classroom allowed me to understand how this knowledge can be applied in practical situations. Teaching and Explanation Skills: One of the most important skills I developed was the ability to explain grammatical concepts. Teaching parts of speech, tenses, and active and passive voice helped me understand that knowing a grammatical rule is different from teaching it effectively. A teacher must explain concepts in a way that students can understand and apply. Communication Skills: Classroom teaching improved my ability to communicate with students. I learned the importance of using clear language, giving understandable examples, listening to students' questions, and responding appropriately. Effective communication is essential for creating a positive learning environment. Classroom Management: Working with students from different academic levels helped me understand the importance of maintaining classroom discipline and keeping students focused on the lesson. I also realized that students may have different levels of understanding and require different types of explanation and support. Time Management: Conducting approximately three hours of classes and remaining at the institution for additional time taught me the importance of managing my daily schedule. I learned that teachers need to organize their lessons and use classroom time effectively. Confidence and Professional Responsibility: Regular interaction with students helped me become more confident in delivering lessons. It also increased my awareness of the responsibilities associated with the teaching profession, including preparation, punctuality, patience, and commitment. Application of Applied Linguistics: My academic background in Applied English Linguistics provided a theoretical foundation for my teaching practice. Concepts related to grammar, language structure, and language learning became more

meaningful when I explained them to students. I understood that linguistic knowledge should not remain limited to theoretical study; it should also be applied to solve practical language-learning difficulties.

5. Challenges Faced

Although the internship provided valuable teaching experience, I also faced some challenges during the process. These challenges helped me understand the difference between academic expectations and the practical responsibilities of working in an educational institution. One of the major challenges was the workload and daily schedule. Although I joined the institution as an intern to gain professional experience and develop my teaching abilities, I sometimes felt that I was being treated more like a regular employee than an intern. I was responsible for conducting classes for approximately three hours a day. This required continuous preparation, classroom interaction, and the responsibility of teaching students effectively. Another challenge was the additional waiting time at the institution. After completing approximately three hours of teaching, I was required to remain at school for around two more hours. During this period, I mostly had to wait rather than perform specific teaching-related activities. This made my daily schedule lengthy and sometimes reduced the time available for my personal academic activities. I also experienced the general challenges associated with teaching students from different academic levels. Students do not always understand grammatical concepts at the same pace. Some concepts require repeated explanations and additional examples. Therefore, I had to make an effort to explain grammar in a simple and understandable way. Another important challenge was connecting theoretical grammatical knowledge with practical teaching. As a Master's student of Applied English Linguistics, I have studied language and grammar academically, but explaining these concepts to students requires different skills. I realized that a teacher must understand students' difficulties and select suitable methods to make lessons effective. Despite these challenges, I tried to fulfil my responsibilities with patience and commitment. The experience taught me to adapt to professional situations, manage my time, and recognize the importance of a balanced and well-organized internship program.

6. Conclusion and Suggestions

In conclusion, my teaching internship at The Pioneers School and College, Jamshoro Campus, was an important step in my academic and professional development. It provided me with an opportunity to apply my knowledge of English grammar in a real classroom environment and gain practical teaching experience. Teaching students of Grade 9, Matriculation, and First Year helped me improve my communication, explanation, classroom management, and time-management skills. The experience also helped me understand that teaching is not simply the delivery of information; it requires preparation, patience, responsibility, and an understanding of students' learning needs. Although I faced challenges related to workload, waiting time, and the practical application of theoretical knowledge, these experiences contributed to my professional learning and helped me better understand the realities of the teaching profession. Based on my experience, I would like to offer some suggestions for improving future internship programmes First, institutions should provide interns with clearly defined responsibilities and reasonable working hours. Interns should be given responsibilities according to the objectives of their training rather than being treated entirely like regular employees. Second, unnecessary waiting time should be reduced, and interns should be provided with meaningful academic activities, such as classroom observation, lesson planning, and teaching discussions. Third, experienced teachers should provide regular guidance and constructive feedback to help interns identify their strengths and areas for improvement. Finally, interns should be encouraged to use student-centred teaching methods, classroom activities, and regular assessments to make the learning process more effective. I also believe that universities and internship institutions should maintain better coordination to ensure that internship programmes provide genuine professional development opportunities. Overall, this experience has strengthened my interest in English language teaching and encouraged me to continue improving my academic knowledge and practical teaching abilities.